

ESRA NUR TURAN-KÜÇÜK

Postdoctoral Researcher | Harvard Graduate School of Education

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ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Harvard University, Cambridge, MA

June 2026–Present

Postdoctoral Researcher, Harvard Graduate School of Education

- PI: Elizabeth Bonawitz, Ph.D.

Harvard University, Cambridge, MA

January 2026–May 2026

Researcher, Harvard Graduate School of Education

- PI: Elizabeth Bonawitz, Ph.D.

EDUCATION

Boston University, Boston, MA

May 2026

Ph.D., Developmental Science, Department of Psychological and Brain Sciences

- Advisor: Melissa M. Kibbe, Ph.D.
- Dissertation: The Development and Format of Possibility Representations in Young Children

Boston University, Boston, MA

May 2022

M.A., Psychological and Brain Sciences, College of Arts and Sciences

Istanbul Sehir University, Istanbul, Türkiye

June 2019

B.A., Psychology, Faculty of Humanities and Social Sciences

- GPA: 4.00/4.00, High Honors
- Thesis Advisor: Fatima Tuba Yaylaci, Ph.D.
- Honors Thesis: Young Children's Representations of Possibility: The Effect of Active Participation in the Differentiation of Possibility vs. Impossibility

PUBLICATIONS

1. Turan-Küçük, E. N., Alderete, S., Xu, F., & Kibbe, M. M. (2026). Ancillary cognitive demands impact children's behavior in common possibility reasoning tasks. *Developmental Psychology*. Advance online publication. <https://doi.org/10.1037/dev0002258>
2. Turan-Küçük, E. N., & Kibbe, M. M. (2026). Children's representations of possibility: Uncertainty about "what" is easier than uncertainty about "where." *Open Mind: Discoveries in Cognitive Science*, 10, 951–962. <https://doi.org/10.1162/opmi.a.364>
3. Turan-Küçük, E. N., & Kibbe, M. M. (2026). Children's reasoning about possible outcomes of events in the present and the future. *Developmental Psychology*, 62(3), 572–582. <https://doi.org/10.1037/dev0002028>
4. Turan-Küçük, E. N., & Kibbe, M. M. (2025). Three- and four-year-old children represent mutually exclusive possible identities. *Journal of Experimental Child Psychology*, 249, 106078. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jecp.2024.106078>
5. Turan-Küçük, E. N., & Kibbe, M. M. (2024). Three-year-olds' ability to plan for mutually exclusive future possibilities is limited primarily by their representations of possible plans, not possible events. *Cognition*, 244, 105712. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.cognition.2023.105712>
6. Williams-Gant, A. J., Weisman, K., Amin, T. G., ... Turan-Küçük, E. N., ... Richert, R. A. (2025). Working across religions, cultures, settings, and development: Protocol for wave 2 data collection with children and parents by the Developing Belief Network. *PLOS ONE*, 20(9), e0330727. <https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0330727>

Manuscripts Under Review

Turan-Küçük, E. N., & Kelemen, D. Do children adopt a moral hierarchy when reasoning about living and non-living entities? Manuscript under review at Psychological Science.

Turan-Küçük, E. N., & Kibbe, M. M. Does temporal context shape children's reasoning about possibility? A Bayesian meta-analysis of children's reasoning under physical and epistemic uncertainty. Manuscript under review at Developmental Science.

Turan-Küçük, E. N., & Yaylaci, F. T. Developmental Changes in Reasoning About Possibility in Turkish Children: The Role of Active Participation. Manuscript under review at JECP.

Manuscripts in Preparation

Turan-Küçük, E. N., & Kibbe, M. M. Do infants have an early-emerging concept of plants as categorically different from animate agents or inanimate objects? Registered report in preparation.

GRANTS & FELLOWSHIPS

Fulbright Ph.D. Scholarship, Fulbright Scholar Program, Fulbright Turkey	2020–2026
Recruitment Manager Fellowship, Boston University	2022–2026
Diverse Intelligences Summer Institute (DISI) Travel Grant — \$1,300	2024
Summer Mini Travel Grant, Center for Innovation in Social Science — \$1,500	2024
Clara Mayo Memorial Fellowship — \$1,260	2024
Clara Mayo Memorial Fellowship — \$810	2023
Cognitive Development Society Diversity Travel Grant — \$750	2022
Clara Mayo Memorial Fellowship — \$520	2022
Clara Mayo Memorial Fellowship — \$5,586	2021
Teaching Fellowship, Boston University	2021–2022

HONORS & AWARDS

Trio Alpha Honor Society, First-Generation College and Graduate Student	2020–2026
B.A. with High Honors, Istanbul Sehir University	2019
Academic Success Scholarship for Outstanding Achievement	2016–2019
1st Place, Psychology, TÜBİTAK Research Project Competition	2013
1st Place, Sociology, TÜBİTAK Research Project Competition	2012

INVITED TALKS

The Development and Format of Possibility Representations in Young Children. (2026, Spring) Talk Presented at Departmental Colloquium, Central European University.

Young children reason about possibilities in the future and the present. (2024, Fall) Talk presented at MIT Early Childhood Cognition Lab, run by Laura Schulz, Massachusetts Institute of Technology.

Young Children's Ability to Plan for Mutually Exclusive Future Possibilities Is Limited Primarily by Their Representations of Possible Plans, Not Possible Events. (2024, Spring) Talk presented at Yale Infant Mind & Cognition Lab, run by Nicolò Cesana-Arlotti, Yale University.

Young Children's Understanding of Future Possibilities. (2024, Spring) Talk presented at Developmental Lab run by Fatima Tuba Yaylaci, Fatih Sultan Mehmet (FSM) University, Istanbul, Türkiye.

Three-Year-Olds' Ability to Plan for Mutually Exclusive Future Possibilities Is Limited Primarily by Their Representations of Possible Plans, Not Possible Events. (2024, Spring) Talk presented at HGSE, Harvard, co run by Paul Harris and Meredith Rowe, Harvard University.

Young Children's Ability to Plan for Mutually Exclusive Future Possibilities Is Limited Primarily by Their Representations of Possible Plans, Not Possible Events. (2024, Spring) Talk presented at Early Learning and Cognition Lab, run by Caren Walker, USCD.

Developmental Changes in Moral Hierarchy between Living and Non-living Things (2022, September) Talk presented at the Child Cognition Lab, Boston University.

Young Children Recognize the Optimal Strategy for Acting on Multiple Possibilities (2022, Spring) Talk presented at the Lab for Developmental Studies, Carey Lab, Harvard University.

Three- and 4-year-olds Recognize the Optimal Strategy for Acting on Multiple Possibilities (2022, Spring). Talk presented at the Developmental Science Colloquium Series, Brown Bag Presentation, Boston University.

Do Young Children Expect Others to Behave Efficiently When Faced with Multiple Possibilities? (2021, Spring). Talk presented at the Developmental Science Colloquium Series, Meeting of the Minds, Boston University.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Oral Presentations

Turan-Küçük, E. N., & Kibbe, M. M. (2026). How do children think about possibilities in the past and the future? Cognitive Development Society Biennial Meeting (CDS), Montreal, Canada.

Turan-Küçük, E. N., & Kibbe, M. M. (2024). Young children's ability to reason about multiple, mutually exclusive object identities. Society for Philosophy and Psychology (SPP), Purdue University, West Lafayette, IN.

Turan-Küçük, E. N., & Kibbe, M. M. (2023). Early emergence of reasoning about multiple, mutually exclusive possible events and objects. Society for Research in Child Development (SRCD), Salt Lake City, UT.

Turan-Küçük, E. N., & Kibbe, M. M. (2023). Early emergence of reasoning about multiple, mutually exclusive possible events and objects. Eastern Psychological Association (EPA), Boston, MA.

Turan-Küçük, E. N., & Kibbe, M. M. (2022). Three- and 4-year-olds recognize the optimal strategy for acting on multiple possibilities. Data-blitz talk, Cognitive Development Society Biennial Pre-Conference Workshop: Possibility Judgments, Madison, WI.

Posters

Turan-Küçük, E. N., & Kibbe, M. M. (2026). What is inside plants? Young children's understanding of the internal structures of living and non-living things. Workshop in Social Cognitive Development at Harvard University (WISCD), Boston, MA.

Turan-Küçük, E. N., & Kibbe, M. M. (2025). Children's reasoning about possible outcomes of events in the present and the future. Society for Philosophy and Psychology (SPP), Cornell University, Ithaca, NY.

Turan-Küçük, E. N., & Kibbe, M. M. (2024). Young children's understanding of others' actions on mutually exclusive possibilities. Cognitive Development Society Biennial Conference (CDS), Pasadena, CA.

Turan-Küçük, E. N., & Kelemen, D. (2024). Do children adopt a moral hierarchy when reasoning about living and non-living entities? Cognitive Development Society Biennial Conference (CDS), Pasadena, CA.

Turan-Küçük, E. N., & Kibbe, M. M. (2024). Do infants have an early-emerging concept of plants as categorically different from animate agents or inanimate objects? Budapest CEU Conference on Cognitive Development (BCCCD), Budapest, Hungary.

Turan-Küçük, E. N., & Kibbe, M. M. (2024). Young children's ability to plan for mutually exclusive possible events in the present and future. Budapest CEU Conference on Cognitive Development (BCCCD), Budapest, Hungary.

Turan-Küçük, E. N., & Kibbe, M. M. (2023). How do young children act on mutually exclusive possible events in the present and future? Society for Research in Child Development (SRCD), Salt Lake City, UT.

Turan-Küçük, E. N., & Kibbe, M. M. (2022). Three- and 4-year-olds recognize the optimal strategy for acting on multiple possibilities. Cognitive Development Society Biennial Conference (CDS), Madison, WI.

Turan-Küçük, E. N., & Kibbe, M. M. (2021). Do young children expect others to act efficiently when faced with multiple possibilities? Harvard Women in Psychology Trends in Psychology Virtual Summit, Boston, MA.

Turan-Küçük, E. N., & Kibbe, M. M. (2021). Do infants have an early-emerging concept of plants as categorically different from non-alive objects? Harvard Women in Psychology Trends in Psychology Virtual Summit, Boston, MA.

Turan-Küçük, E. N., & Yaylaci, F. T. (2020). Young children's representation of possibility and logical inferences: They differentiate possibility vs. impossibility. Budapest CEU Conference on Cognitive Development (BCCCD), Budapest, Hungary.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor

MEF University, Istanbul, Türkiye

Fall 2024

Sole Instructor — Social Cognition

Ihsan International School, Istanbul, Türkiye

Sep–Dec 2020

AP Psychology Teacher (Part-time)

Invited Guest Lectures

UMass Lowell — Child and Adolescent Development

Fall 2024

Invited Lecturer

- Lecture: Young Children's Representations of Possibilities
- Invited by Jiabin Shen, Ph.D.

Occidental College — Developmental Psychology

Fall 2023

Invited Lecturer

- Lecture: Young Children's Understanding of Possibility
- Invited by Jamie Amemiya, Ph.D.

UMass Boston — Introduction to Psychology

Fall 2023

Invited Lecturer

- Lecture: Conceptual Development
- Invited by Kubra Tor-Cabuk

Teaching Assistantships

Boston University, Boston, MA

Summer 2023

Graduate Teaching Fellow — AIM Program

- Introduction to Psychology; Experimental Psychology; Cognitive Development

Boston University, Boston, MA <i>Graduate Teaching Fellow — Psychology 101: General Psychology</i>	Sep 2022–May 2023
Istanbul Sehir University, Istanbul, Türkiye <i>Undergraduate Teaching Assistant</i> • Cognitive Psychology; Research Methods	Oct 2017–May 2018
Istanbul Sehir University, Istanbul, Türkiye <i>Undergraduate Teaching Assistant — Adolescence</i>	Oct 2017–Jan 2018

RESEARCH LEADERSHIP, MENTORSHIP & OUTREACH

Boston University Child Development Labs, Boston, MA <i>Family Recruitment Coordinator</i> • Coordinated participant recruitment across six child development laboratories and large-scale family and community events throughout the Boston area. • Built and maintained partnerships with local parent groups, playgroups, and community organizations to support family recruitment and research participation. • Managed a shared participant database used across laboratories to recruit children and families for developmental research studies. • Trained undergraduate research assistants in participant recruitment procedures, database protocols, and research policies.	May 2022–2026
Museum of Science, Cambridge, MA <i>Living Lab Scientist & Teen Scientist Professional Development Series Leader</i> • Conducted developmental research with children and families in a public museum setting, including participant recruitment, consent, and data collection. • Engaged families and museum visitors with developmental science research and communicated research questions and findings to broad public audiences. • Led professional development programming for teen scientists, providing mentorship and training in research and science communication.	September 2021–2026
Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (DEI) Committee, Boston University <i>Committee Member</i>	September 2020–2026
Boston University Summer Internship Program <i>Professional Development Workshop Leader/Presenter</i> • Designed and led professional development workshops for undergraduate summer research interns.	2021–2022

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Society for Philosophy and Psychology (SPP) <i>Executive Committee Member</i>	2026–2029
Society for Philosophy and Psychology (SPP) <i>Diversity Committee Member</i>	2024–Present

ADDITIONAL TRAINING

Diverse Intelligences Summer Institute (DISI), University of St Andrews, UK	Summer 2024
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SKILLS

Languages: Turkish (native); English (fluent)
Quantitative & Research Tools: R, SPSS, Datavyu, Qualtrics; basic Python and NVivo

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

Society for Philosophy and Psychology (SPP)
Cognitive Development Society
Society for Research in Child Development
American Psychological Association
International Congress on Infant Studies